

A FREE GUIDE BY @AISSAKEE

How I Make Money as a *Student*

One laptop, three streams,
real numbers.

Hi, I'm *Kee*

I'm a full-time student in Toronto, a self-taught designer, and the founder of Kreeative, a small design studio I run from my laptop.

I've worked with brands like The Ordinary, COSRX, Beauty of Joseon, CapCut and YesStyle, I've pitched over 200 brands myself, and I worked a part-time retail job all summer.

This is the system I actually use, with the real numbers, including the ones that aren't impressive.

THE TRUTH FIRST

The job paid more than the laptop *this summer*

THE PART-TIME
JOB

\$5,400

11 paycheques,
March to August
2026. Between
\$450 and \$670
every two weeks.

THE LAPTOP

[\$laptop total]

My online shop \$687.86 · Kreeative card payments
\$107 · brand gigs \$830 (paid, to confirm) · clients
paid another way [\$invoices], January to
September 2026.

I'm not going to tell you I replaced my job. The job pays the same every two weeks. The skill is the one that can grow, and it pays more per hour: one \$419 order took me [X] hours. The same \$419 at the job is [Y] shifts.

Three streams, one skill. Here is each one, and exactly how I started it.

STREAM ONE • DESIGN FOR SMALL BUSINESSES

Start with the thing they need *every week*

Businesses around you need a flyer every week: a promo, an event, a menu, a hiring post. It is the fastest skill to learn and the easiest first sale.

- 1** **Learn Canva in three days.** One template style, one colour palette, one font pair. Good enough beats perfect.
- 2** **Make three concept samples for real businesses near you** and label them "concept". A restaurant, a salon, an event.
- 3** **Send five DMs a day** with the matching concept attached. The DM is on the next page.
- 4** **Price it at \$95** for the first five, then raise it. That is my public price for an essential flyer.

THE DM

Four lines that get *replies*

Hi [name], I'm Kee, a designer in Toronto.

I noticed [one specific thing about their page].

I made you a quick concept (attached). If you like it, I can have the final ready by [day].

No pressure either way.

- **Specific to them.** One real thing about their page, not "I love your brand".
- **Free value first.** The concept is attached, not promised.
- **A date.** A date makes it real.
- **No pressure.** It is the line people reply to.

Five a day, every day. That is the whole secret.

STREAM TWO • BRAND GIGS AND UGC

One page beats *10K followers*

Brands pay for content, not for followers. My biggest gig came from a pitch, not from a feed. What gets the yes is one page: the media kit.

WHAT IS ON THE ONE PAGE

- **Who you are** in one line, and the kind of content you make.
- **Your numbers**, even small ones, with context: views, engagement, where your audience is.
- **Three content examples** that look like what the brand would post.
- **Rates**, or "rates on request", and how to reach you.

Post about the category before you pitch. A brand will look at your last nine posts, and they should already look like the collaboration.

THE PITCH

Short, specific, *one idea*

Hi [brand] team, I'm Kee, a content creator in Toronto.

I've been using [one product] and I have one idea for it:
[the idea in one line].

My audience: [your numbers, with context]. Media kit attached.

Would you be open to a paid collaboration or a product send?

One idea per pitch. One product. One ask. Pitch five brands for every one you hope to hear from, and keep posting about the category in between.

The full version, with where I find brands and how I follow up, is in my free brand-deal guide at kreative.xyz/teach.

STREAM THREE · THE ONLINE SHOP

Sell the thing people keep *asking for*

My third stream is a product, not a service: an online shop I run on Shopify. One product line, one page, one link in bio. Here is how the first orders actually went:

ORDER	DATE	AMOUNT	WHAT HAPPENED
#1001	29 July	\$0.00	Me, testing my own checkout.
#1002	29 August	\$419.00	The first real sale, from a stranger I had never met.
#1003	21 September	\$268.86	Three items in one order.

Price it properly from day one. Put the link where your audience already is. Then improve the product page every time someone asks a question before buying.

THE WEEK

The routine that makes it *real*

EVERY DAY

WHAT

5 DMs	To businesses, each with a concept attached.
1 pitch	To a brand, with the media kit.
1 post	About the category you want to be paid in.

EVERY WEEK

3 samples	New concept samples for new businesses.
1 improvement	To the product, from a real question.

SUNDAY

Scoreboard	DMs sent, replies, pitches, invoices. Keep the number honest.
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PRICING

What I charge, so you have a *reference*

My public prices, in CAD plus tax. Start at the bottom of the list and raise after five clients.

FLYERS

REELS (UP TO 60 S)

WEBSITES

Essential **\$95**

Essential from **\$160**

Starter **\$1,500**

Event pack **\$175**

Dynamic **\$210**

Shop **\$3,000**

Full event kit **\$325**

Signature **\$265**

Full custom **\$5,000**

The first time I said those numbers out loud I was scared. Clients were not.

IF I STARTED TODAY

The first *seven days*

- 1* **Days 1 to 3:** learn Canva, one template style. Make three concept flyers for three real businesses near you.
- 2* **Day 4:** write your one-page media kit, even with small numbers. Put "concept" on every sample.
- 3* **Days 4 to 7:** five DMs a day with the four lines, one brand pitch a day. That is twenty DMs and four pitches by Sunday.
- 4* **Sunday:** count replies, not likes. Fix the DM, not the logo. Go again Monday.

You do not need followers to start. You need one skill, three samples and five messages a day.

NEXT

Where to go *from here*

- **Free brand-deal guide** (EN + FR): how I get PR packages and paid brand deals. kreative.xyz/teach
- **Media kit templates** (Canva), the ones I use. kreative.xyz/shop
- **UGC Creator Formation**, \$59 USD: learn to pitch, price and deliver paid brand work, with a certificate at the end and a free media kit included. kreative.xyz/teach
- **Want it done for you?** Websites, flyers and Reels by Kreative. 10 founding client spots in October at 10% off: comment **SPOT** on any post.

Follow **@aissakee** for the real numbers every week, and **@bykreative** for the studio.

Start before you feel ready. I posted my first one at 31 followers.